

manufacturer itself, thereby making it very inconvenient as well as expensive.

If you are confused about buying an EV, the best option for you is to buy a hybrid gas/electric automobile. It is environmentally friendly and more efficient than a conventional gas-fueled car. A hybrid vehicle's battery gets charged during driving itself.

Top EVs unleashed at Auto Expo 2020

At the biggest automobile trade show in India, Auto Expo 2020, car manufacturers from various countries unveiled their new EVs including concept vehicles. Global Indian car maker, Mahindra and Mahindra, launched their new electric passenger car, dubbed eKUV100. It also announced the launch of two more electric cars, XUV300 and Atom, later this year.

Tata Motors made its presence felt at the show with the plan of launching four electric cars over the next two years, along with an electric low-floor bus and an ultra-electric truck.

Maruti Suzuki India unleashed its Futuro-E concept EV. This is the second time the company has showcased a concept vehicle but is yet to launch a full EV on Indian roads.

Other EVs showcased at the expo are given next.

Tata Altroz EV. Tata Motors displayed its third electric passenger car, which was earlier displayed at 2019 Geneva Motor Show. Altroz EV will be the first premium hatchback in India, claims Tata. It will be furnished with Ziptron electric power train technology, which implies it would provide an electric range of over 250 kilometres on a single charge. Also, it is speculated to appear with an eight-year warranty of battery and IP67 certification.

Mercedes-Benz EQC. The German car maker displayed its upcoming EQC EV at Auto Expo 2020 show, ahead of its global launch in April this year. It is Mercedes' first electric car in India, which the company claims, will provide a range of 470 kilometres on a single charge.

The company will unleash this model in India as EQC edition 1886. The car utilises 80kWh floor-mounted battery pack to power two electric motors, while the company proclaimed

during the show that the car has the potential to go from zero to hundred kilometres per hour in 5.1 seconds. Its fast charging feature helps it to go from ten to eighty per cent charge in forty minutes.

Renault City K-ZE. The French multinational car maker showcased its new electric passenger car in India, known as Renault City K-ZE, which is the electric version of its most sold car, Kwid. It was first unveiled at 2019 Shanghai Motor Show and is based on K-ZE concept. K-ZE is coupled with a 33kW motor that is capable of delivering 120Nm of peak torque. Since charging is a major concern in EVs, K-ZE can be charged with standard 220V domestic and plug charging points. Its first charging mode will get it charged up to eighty per cent in just fifty minutes.

Mahindra eKUV. Mahindra & Mahindra, one of the most profitable car-makers in India, introduced eKUV. The car looks similar to its traditional SUV, though some exterior features have been added to make it look like an EV. According to the company, it will be the most affordable electric passenger car in India. Its power will be 40kW electric, which will belt out about 53bhp and 120Nm of peak torque. It will appear with 15.9kWh lithium-ion battery, which is expected to offer a range of 120 kilometres on a single charge.

GMW Ora R1. China's Great Wall Motors is entering India with the launch of its new and affordable electric car GMW R1 hatchback, which is expected to be available in India in the coming months. Along with integration of daytime running lamps, the car is backed by 33kWh battery pack that generates a maximum of 47bhp and peak torque of 125Nm. Top speed is hundred kilometres per hour. With fast-charging option, the car can be charged to eighty per cent in just forty minutes using DC charger.

Mahindra eXUV300. This car will come in standard and long-range variants, and will offer a range of up to 200 kilometres and 350-400 kilometres, respectively, on a single charge. It will produce 130bhp of power output and have a maximum range of 300 kilometres from its 40kWh lithium-ion battery pack. **EFY**

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